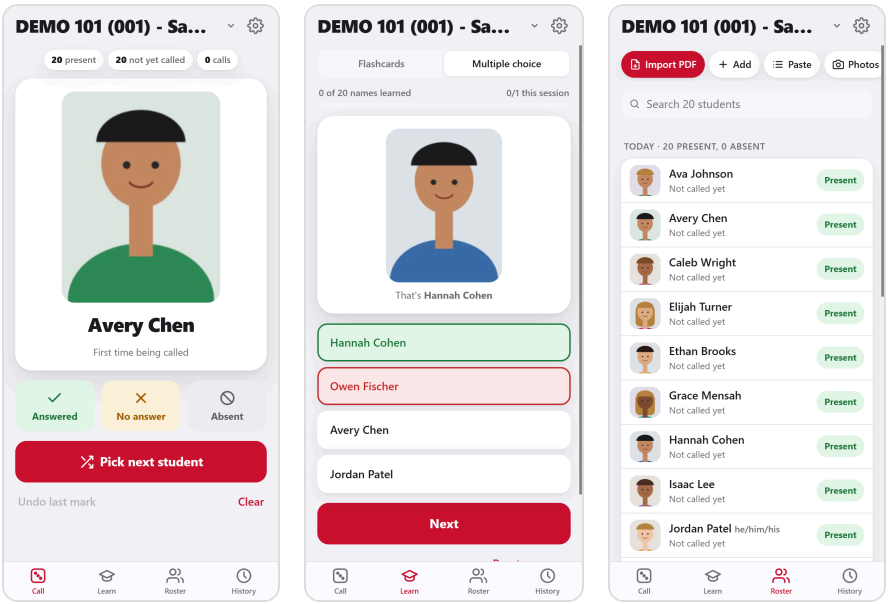
Roster Caller

Cold-call students fairly, keep attendance, and learn names, all from your iPhone.

Roster Caller picks a student at random and shows their photo and name, then you tap **Answered**, **No answer**, or **Absent**. Over the semester it balances who gets called, so students who have been called least come up first. You can export the records as CSV at any time. A separate **Learn** mode helps you learn students' names from their photos.

You set it up by importing the class photo roster PDF from MyPack Portal. **Student information never leaves your phone.** The PDF is read on the phone itself, and nothing is uploaded.



All screenshots use a fictional sample class with cartoon avatars. No real students are shown.

Open the app: https://tnaziz.github.io/RosterCaller/

Why I built this

I got tired of keeping track of the students I was calling on with a paper printout of my photo roster, so I decided to vibe code this app with Claude. Now I pick students, mark answers, and take attendance on my phone, and the app keeps the records for me.

A note on compatibility: Roster Caller is built specifically for the photo roster PDF that NC State's MyPack Portal exports. I'm not sure how well it works with rosters from other systems. It's open source and free for anyone to use, so feel free to adjust it to fit your needs.

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- **Getting started:** 1. Set up · 2. Get your photo roster · 3. Import it
- **Using it:** 4. Call on students · 5. Learn names · 6. Attendance and roster · 7. History and CSV export · 8. Settings, backups, new semester
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What it does

Feature	What it means
Random, fair calling	Picks a present student at random, favoring those called least. Calls are balanced across the whole semester, not per day.
One-tap records	Mark each call **Answered**, **No answer**, or **Absent**. Every mark is saved with the date and time.
Photo roster import	Reads the MyPack Portal *Faculty Class Photo Roster* PDF, including photos, names, student IDs, pronouns, and FERPA flags.
Attendance	Mark students absent for the day so they aren't picked.
Name practice	Flashcards and multiple choice. The names you miss come back more often.
CSV export	Call log, per-student summary, and attendance by date, with student IDs for your gradebook.
Several classes	Keep each section separate and switch with the class menu at the top.
Works offline	Once installed, it works without a connection.

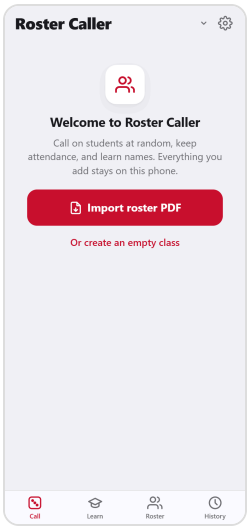
Privacy

- Rosters, photos, IDs, and records are stored **only on your phone**, in the app's own storage. They are never sent to GitHub or anywhere else.
- The roster PDF is read on the phone with pdf.js. It is bundled with the app, so nothing is loaded from other sites.
- Information leaves the phone only when you send it yourself, such as a CSV export or backup file you email or save to iCloud Drive. Students' photos are part of their educational records, so treat exports, backups, and the roster PDF with the same care.
- Students marked `*` on the roster have additional FERPA restrictions. The app shows a **FERPA** tag next to their name as a reminder.

1. Set up (once per phone)

You need an iPhone or iPad with iOS 16.4 or later.

1. On your iPhone, open **Safari** and go to **https://tnaziz.github.io/RosterCaller/**.
2. Tap the **Share** button (the square with an arrow), then **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.
3. From now on, open **Roster Caller** from its Home Screen icon. It opens full-screen like an app, works offline, and iOS keeps its data more reliably than in a Safari tab.

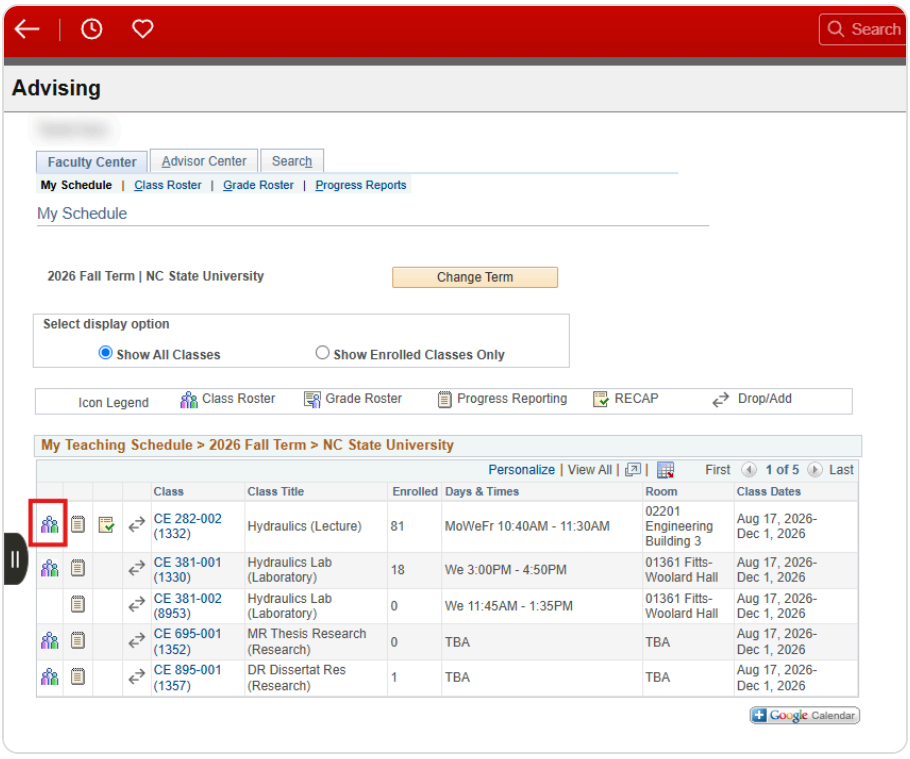


> **Want to try it before using a real class?** Use the sample roster: on your iPhone, open https://tnaziz.github.io/RosterCaller/samples/Sample_Roster.pdf, tap **Share** → **Save to Files**, and import it as in step 3. It has 20 fictional students. Delete the class afterwards in **Settings** → **Delete this class**.

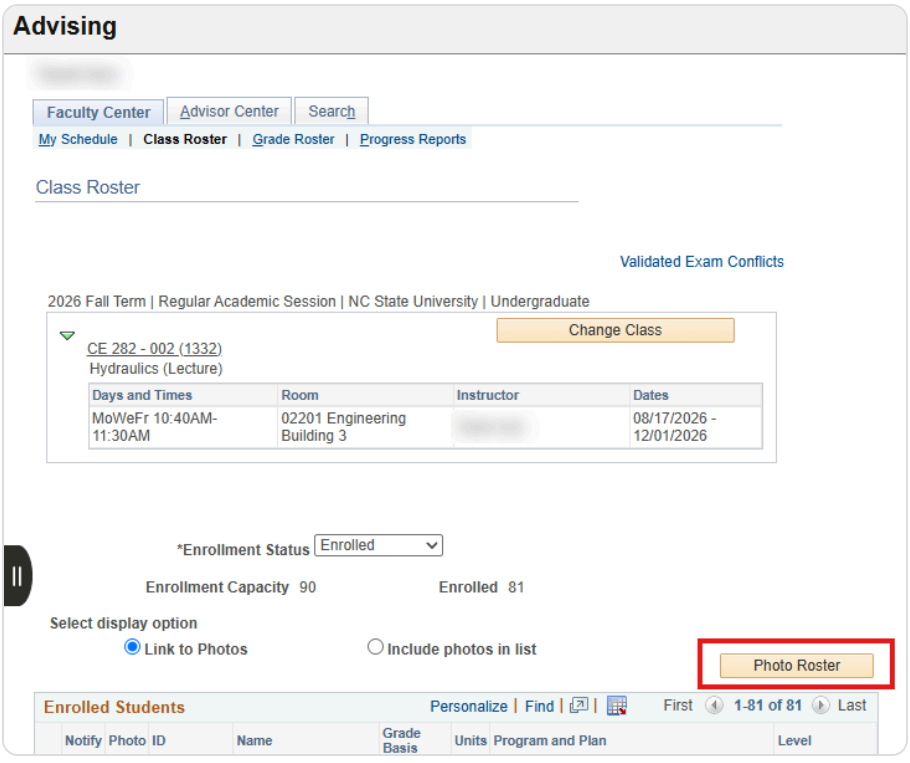
2. Get your photo roster from MyPack Portal

The app reads the **Faculty Class Photo Roster** PDF from **MyPack Portal**.

1. Sign in to **MyPack Portal** and open the Faculty page. It is titled **Advising**, with **Faculty Center**, **Advisor Center**, and **Search** tabs. Stay on **Faculty Center**.
2. Under **My Schedule**, check the term at the top. Click **Change Term** if it isn't the current one.
3. Under **My Teaching Schedule**, click the **Class Roster** icon (the small group of people) at the left of your class's row.



4. On the **Class Roster** page, leave **Enrollment Status** set to **Enrolled**, then click **Photo Roster**. The button is on the right, just above the *Enrolled Students* list. (To switch to a different class from this page, use **Change Class**.)



5. A PDF opens with every enrolled student's photo, student ID, and name. Its first page is headed *Faculty Class Photo Roster* and shows the class, term, and *Roster Count*. **Download or save this**

PDF. It is the file you import into Roster Caller.

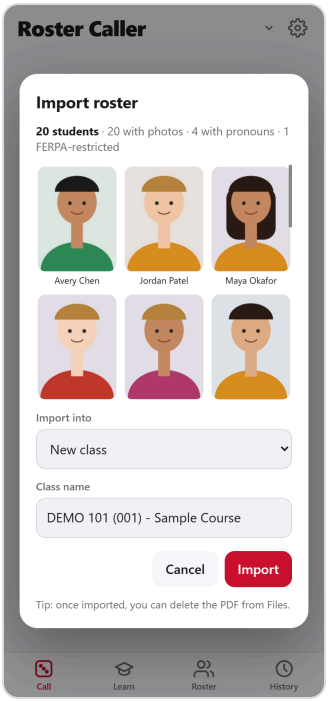
6. Put the PDF on your iPhone in **Files**. Either:
   - download it on the iPhone itself (in Safari, tap **Share** → **Save to Files**), or
   - download it on your computer and **AirDrop** it to the iPhone, then choose **Save to Files**.

   Saving it under **On My iPhone** rather than **iCloud Drive** keeps it off the cloud.

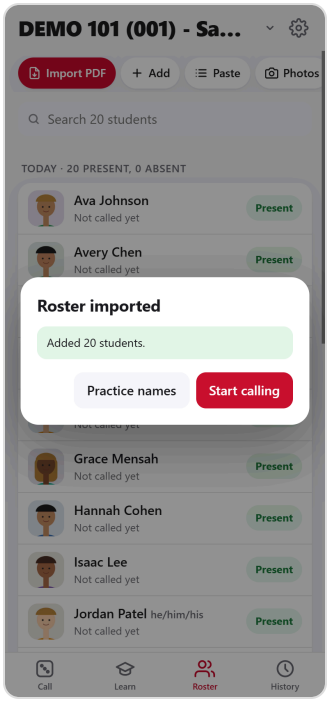
> Use the PDF exactly as downloaded. A scan, a photo, or a screenshot of the roster will not import.

3. Import the roster

1. Open Roster Caller and tap **Import roster PDF**, or **Import PDF** on the **Roster** tab.
2. Pick the PDF in Files. The app reads it on the phone, which takes a few seconds.
3. Check the preview. It shows how many students were found, how many have photos and pronouns, and every face with its name.
4. Under **Import into**, choose **New class**. The class name is filled in from the roster, and you can edit it. To refresh a class you already have, choose **Update "..."** instead.
5. Tap **Import**.



Check the count and faces, then **Import**



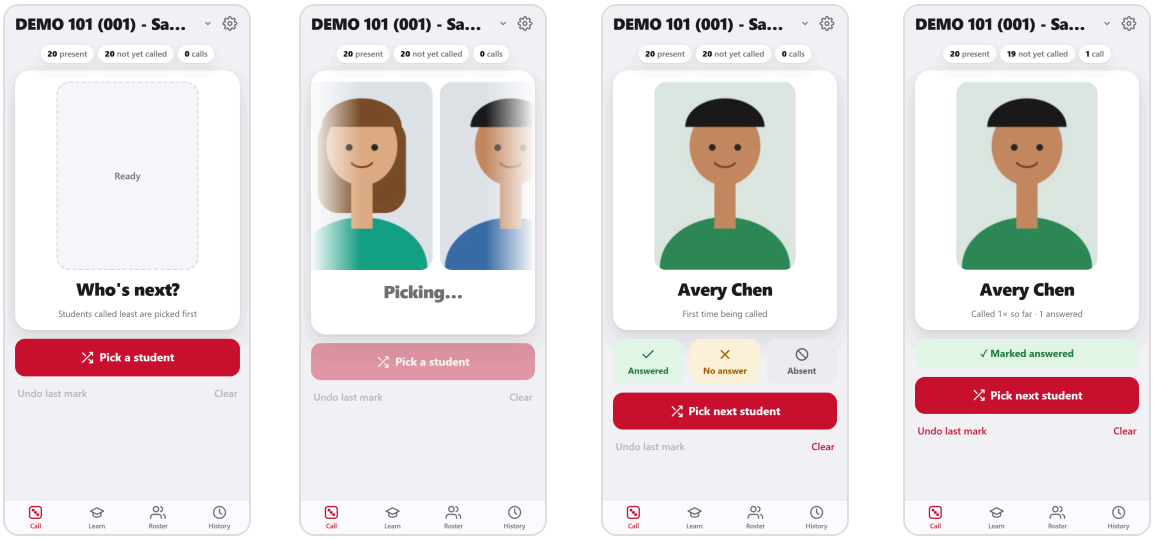
Done. Start calling or practice names

Good to know

- If the number of students found doesn't match the *Roster Count* on the PDF, the app warns you. This usually means pages are missing from the PDF.
- **Re-importing is safe.** When students add or drop the class, download a new roster and import it into the same class with **Update "..."**. Students are matched by student ID and then by name. Their call history is kept, new students are added, and names, pronouns, and photos are refreshed. Students no longer on the roster are kept, and the app tells you how many, so you can delete them yourself if they dropped.
- Once imported, you can delete the PDF from Files.

4. Call on students

1. Go to the **Call** tab and tap **Pick a student**.
2. Faces slide past and stop on one student, whose name and pronouns appear.
3. Tap **Answered**, **No answer**, or **Absent**. The mark is saved with today's date.
4. Tap **Pick next student** to continue.



1. Tap **Pick a student** 2. Faces slide past... 3. ...and stop on a student 4. The mark is saved

How picking works

- **Balanced over the semester.** Students with the fewest calls are picked first, counting every class day. Everyone gets called once before anyone is called a second time, and so on. The count never resets by itself; see a new semester.
- The chips at the top show who's present, how many students haven't been called yet, and the total number of calls.
- **Absent** students are skipped for the rest of the day. Marking a picked student **Absent** also marks them absent for today.

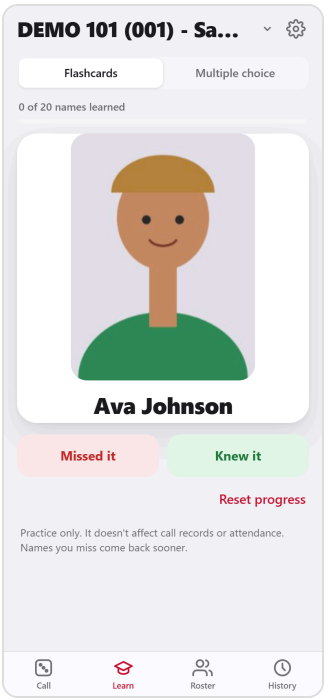
- Made a mistake? Tap **Undo last mark**, or delete any mark later in **History**.
- For pure random picking, turn off **Call least-called first** in Settings. To skip the animation, turn off **Pick animation**. It is also skipped when the iPhone's *Reduce Motion* setting is on.

5. Learn names

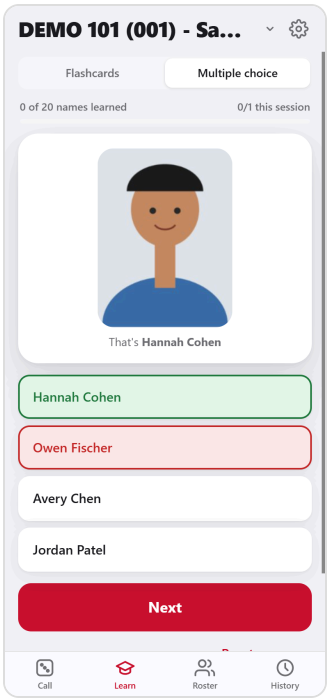
The **Learn** tab is for practice only. It never changes call records or attendance.

- **Flashcards:** look at the face, tap to reveal the name, then tap **Knew it** or **Missed it**.
- **Multiple choice:** pick the right name out of four.

Names you miss come back sooner. A name counts as learned after you get it right three times in a row, and the bar at the top shows your progress. **Reset progress** starts over.



Flashcards



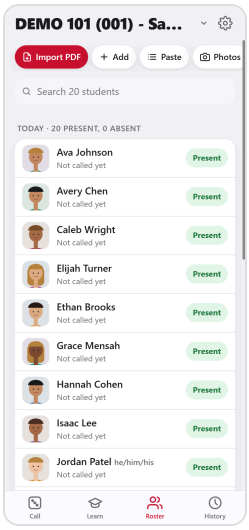
Multiple choice: the correct name turns green

6. Attendance and the roster

On the **Roster** tab:

- Tap **Present / Absent** next to a name to set today's attendance. Absent students are never picked.
- **Search** by name or student ID.
- Tap a student to change their photo, name, pronouns, or ID, see their totals, or delete them.
- Other ways to add students: **Add** one at a time (with a photo from the camera), **Paste** a list of names (one per line; "Last, First" is converted), or **Photos** to import image files named after

students (`Jane Doe.jpg`).

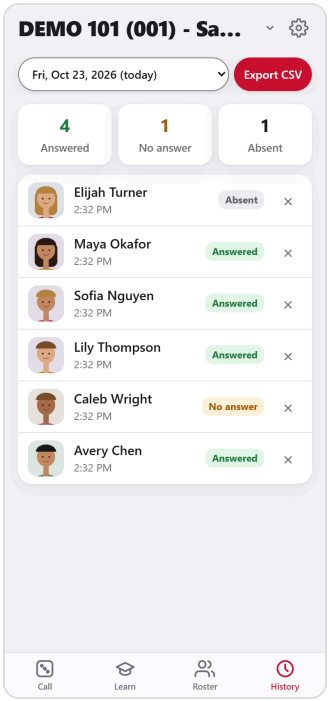


7. History and CSV export

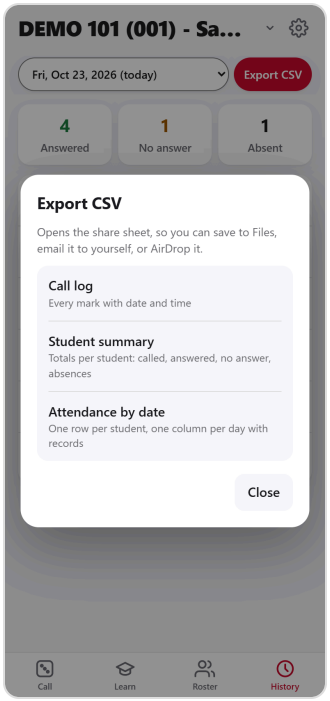
The **History** tab shows each day's marks. Choose a date at the top. Tap **×** to delete a mistaken mark.

Tap **Export CSV** and choose a file. The iPhone share sheet opens, so you can **Save to Files**, email it to yourself, or AirDrop it to your computer. The files open in Excel and Google Sheets.

File	Contents
Call log	One row per mark: date, time, student ID, student, result
Student summary	One row per student: student ID, times called, answered, no answer, absences, % answered
Attendance by date	One row per student and one column per day with records: *Present* or *Absent*



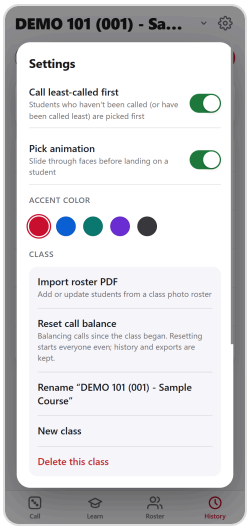
A day's marks



Choose what to export

8. Settings, backups and a new semester

Tap the **gear** at the top right.



- **Call least-called first / Pick animation:** described in Call on students.
- **Accent color:** red, blue, teal, purple, or graphite.
- **Reset call balance:** starts everyone even, so picks come from the whole class again. History and exports keep every record. Use it at the start of a new semester, or whenever you want a fresh rotation.

- **Classes:** import a roster, rename, add, or delete a class. Switch classes with the menu at the top of the screen.
- **Back up all data:** saves one file with every class, photo, and record, through the share sheet. **Restore from backup** loads it on a new or reset phone.

> **Back up now and then.** Deleting the app from the Home Screen deletes its data, and the data doesn't sync between devices. A backup is the only way to move it to a new phone. Backups contain student photos, so keep them somewhere private.

Starting a new semester: import the new roster as a **New class** (recommended, which keeps each semester separate), or delete the old class when you no longer need its records.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
"Couldn't read that PDF" or "No students found"	Use the PDF exactly as downloaded from MyPack Portal, not a scan, a photo, or a printed-to-image copy.
Fewer students than the *Roster Count*	Pages are probably missing from the PDF. Download the full roster and import it again with **Update "..."**.
A photo or name looks wrong	Tap the student on the **Roster** tab to fix it.
The app doesn't show a new feature	Open it once while online, close it, and open it again.
My classes are gone	iOS may have cleared the app's storage, or the app was removed from the Home Screen. **Restore from backup** in Settings.
I want it on my iPad too	Install it there the same way, then use **Back up** on one device and **Restore** on the other.

Sharing with colleagues

Send them the link https://tnaziz.github.io/RosterCaller/ and this guide. Each person's classes and records stay on their own phone, so nobody can see anyone else's data and no accounts are needed.

The PDF import is built for NC State's *Faculty Class Photo Roster*, and I haven't tested rosters from other systems. **Paste** and **Photos** work with any class. If your school's roster PDF doesn't import, the code is open: `roster-pdf.js` is the part to adapt.

To run your own copy, fork this repository and turn on **Settings** → **Pages** → **Deploy from a branch** → `main` **/ (root)**.

License

Roster Caller is released into the **public domain** under The Unlicense. You can use, copy, modify, share, and sell it for any purpose, without asking and without giving credit.

The bundled pdf.js library in `vendor/pdfjs/` is Mozilla's work and keeps its own Apache License 2.0, which is also free to use and share.